HOW TO BE A BETTER RUGBY PLAYER:

"Motivation gets us going, but discipline gets us there."

Be helpful; don't assume that someone else will do the job for you. Be aware of your environment and be on the look out for ways to assist others.
By being aware of your environment and what is going on around you; it will allow you to best position yourself to help the team, whether on attack or defence.

Be polite and well mannered, especially in public places. No one lives in a vacuum and everything that you say and do is noticed by someone. A good impression must be made at all times.
Be disciplined in what you say and do on the field. Team-mates will return the kind of respect that you show towards them, be it positive or negative.

Be courteous to those around you. Get out of the habit of thinking of your own needs first and realise that your actions impact directly on those around you. Be aware of their needs and try and accommodate them as far as possible.
Don't be selfish on the field. Remember that the team's needs come first and sometimes that means sacrificing personal glory for the good of the team.

Speak positively. Try and build up individual players and the team at every opportunity. Often the characteristics that you ascribe to others are reflected on you, whether they are positive or negative.
Be constructive in your communication on the field. Don't shout at and criticise your team-mates - instead, encourage and motivate.

Live healthily. Excessive consumption of alcohol, smoking, poor sleeping patterns and poor diet have a detrimental effect on your health and seriously impacts on your lifespan. Ensure that you follow the lifestyle guidelines for elite sportspeople. A large part of hard work that is done during training is undone by excessive drinking, smoking and poor diet. Your body needs at least 8 hours of sleep to recover. Why bother to fight for every extra edge when you lose ground through your lifestyle choices? After all it is against the school rules!

Be proud of your values and principles. They define who you are as a person. Remember the characteristics of good sportsmanship and try to always apply them.

Be empathetic of others (be aware of what and how they are feeling).
By knowing how others feel and react to various situations it will make you read them on the field better. You will be able to pick up if they are feeling motivated, nervous, lethargic or over-confident and be able to adjust your behaviour to try and change, influence or add to theirs.